18 Last month the cost of using the air pump at a garage was 20p.
This month the cost of using the air pump is 50p.

Tom says,

"50 ÷ 20 = 2.5 so the cost of using the air pump has increased by 250%"

(a) Is Tom correct?
Explain your answer.

No. Increase = 50 – 20 = 30p.

30 ÷ 20 × 100 = 150%, not 250%.

1 mark
Subtract old cost first.

(1)

The normal price of a cooker is £540

Sale price
60% off normal price

Stan has to work out the sale price of the cooker.

Here is his working.

10% of 540 = 54
6 × 54 = 324
Sale price = £324

Stan's answer is wrong.

(b) What mistake has Stan made?

He found the reduction, but did not subtract it from £540. Sale price = £540 – £324 = £216.

1 mark
60% off means 40% remains.

(1)

(Total for Question 18 is 2 marks)